



who will be my goto client

Based on the market research and your business model, here are your **top priority "go-to" clients** for TradePulse, ranked by likelihood to pay, strategic value, and market access:

☑ #1 Priority: FMCG Distributors (Your Best First Client)

Why They're Perfect:

- **Direct pain point:** They lose 3–8% of orders through WhatsApp/manual ordering ^[1]
- **Existing budgets:** Spend R500–R2,000/trader/month on field reps
- **Clear ROI:** TradePulse reduces their costs and increases order volume
- **Easy pilot:** Can start with 50–100 traders in one territory
- **Scalable:** One contract = hundreds of traders onboarded

Top Targets:

Tier 1 (National Distributors)

Company	Why	Contact Strategy
Tiger Brands	Largest FMCG, already has ESD programmes	Pitch to Head of General Trade / Distribution
Shoprite/Checkers	140,000+ spaza relationships via Usave	Pitch to Head of Informal Trade / Supply Chain
Coca-Cola Beverages SA	Massive spaza penetration, digital transformation focus	Pitch to Head of Route-to-Market / Digital Innovation
Pioneer Foods	Bread, maize, sugar – spaza essentials	Pitch to General Trade Director
Unilever SA	Strong ESD focus, digital ordering experiments	Pitch to Customer Development Director

Tier 2 (Regional/Wholesale Distributors)

Company	Why	Contact Strategy
BetaNet W&R Network	Already digital B2B platform for spazas ^[2]	Partnership pitch (integrate TradePulse)
Makro Cash & Carry	Supplies thousands of spazas	Pitch to Head of SME/Spaza Segment
Jumbo Cash & Carry	Major township wholesaler	Pitch to Business Development Manager

Company	Why	Contact Strategy
Local independent distributors	Less bureaucracy, faster decisions	Direct outreach to owners

Pitch to Distributors:

"TradePulse helps you capture 100% of spaza orders, reduce field rep costs by 30%, and never lose a sale to stock-outs again.

For R100/trader/month, you get:

- Real-time visibility into retailer demand
- Automated low-stock alerts
- Reduced order loss (currently 3–8% via WhatsApp)
- Verified trading data for credit decisions

Pilot: 100 traders in Soweto for 3 months. If we don't increase your order volume by 15%, you pay nothing."

☒ #2 Priority: Banks & Alternative Lenders

Why They're Strong:

- **Regulatory pressure:** Need to lend to township MSMEs (B-BBEE, SDA requirements)
- **Data gap:** Can't assess informal businesses without trading history ^[3]
- **High margins:** SME lending is profitable if risk is managed
- **Alternative data trend:** Banks actively seeking non-traditional credit scoring ^[4] ^[5]

Top Targets:

Tier 1 (Major Banks)

Bank	Why	Contact Strategy
African Bank	Township Spark facility, already lending to spazas ^[6]	Pitch to Head of SME Lending / Alternative Credit
Standard Bank	R143.6M ESD disbursement, township economy focus ^[7]	Pitch to Head of Business Banking / ESD
Capitec	Largest informal trader banking presence	Pitch to Head of Business Banking / Innovation
ABSA	R1.2B ESD fund with Heineken, strong SME focus	Pitch to Head of SME / ESD Programme Manager
Nedbank	Strong SME lending, digital innovation	Pitch to Head of Business & Commercial Banking

Tier 2 (Alternative Lenders & Fintechs)

Company	Why	Contact Strategy
Lulalend	SME-focused, alternative credit scoring	Pitch to Head of Credit / Product
Lendico SA	P2P lending, risk assessment innovation	Pitch to CEO / Head of Risk
Finfind	SME finance matching, data gap research ^[3]	Partnership pitch (data provider)
Stitch / Ozow	Payment data for credit scoring	Partnership pitch
Credit bureaus (TransUnion, Experian)	Alternative data initiatives	Pitch to Head of Alternative Data / Innovation

Pitch to Banks:

"TradePulse gives you verified trading history for 1.6M informal MSMEs that banks can't currently assess.

For R15–R20/trader/month, you get:

- 6–12 months of verified sales data
- Revenue trends and consistency scores
- Stock turnover metrics
- Early warning signals (declining revenue, irregular trading)

Pilot: Access to 500 trader profiles. Use our data to approve loans you would have declined. Track repayment rates vs. your traditional scoring."

☒ #3 Priority: Government Programmes

Why They're Strategic:

- **Large budgets:** R710M for TREP, R500M for Spaza Fund ^[8] ^[9]
- **Political mandate:** Need to show results in township economic development
- **Scale:** Can onboard 5,000–10,000 traders in one contract
- **Credibility:** Government endorsement = trust with traders

Top Targets:

National Government

Programme	Budget	Contact Strategy
TREP (Township & Rural Entrepreneurship Programme)	R710M (2026/27) ^[8] ^[9]	Pitch to DSBD Director-General / TREP Programme Manager
IMEDP (Informal Micro Enterprise Development Programme)	R36.7M (2025/26) ^[10]	Pitch to Head of Informal Enterprise Development
Spaza Shop Support Fund	R500M total ^[11] ^[12]	Pitch to DSBD Minister's Office / Fund Administrator
SEDA (Small Enterprise Development Agency)	Part of R2.147B DSBD budget ^[10]	Pitch to CEO / Head of Business Support
SEFA (Small Enterprise Finance Agency)	R3B+ guarantees ^[13]	Pitch to Head of Funding / Alternative Credit

Development Finance Institutions

Institution	Why	Contact Strategy
NEF (National Empowerment Fund)	Spaza Fund administrator ^[14]	Pitch to CEO / Investment Manager
DBSA (Development Bank of Southern Africa)	Township Spark partner ^[6]	Pitch to Head of Inclusive Economy
UNCDF South Africa	Digital spaza initiatives ^[6]	Partnership pitch
UNDP South Africa	Township Spark initiative ^[6]	Partnership pitch

Pitch to Government:

"TradePulse is the digital infrastructure for the R900B township economy.

For R50–R80/trader/year, you get:

- Real-time monitoring of 5,000–10,000 supported businesses
- Verified trading data for funding decisions
- Impact measurement (jobs created, revenue growth)
- POPIA-compliant data management

Pilot: Integrate TradePulse into TREP or Spaza Fund. Track 1,000 businesses for 6 months. Show Cabinet measurable results: 'X businesses supported, Y% revenue growth, Z jobs created.'"

☒ #4 Priority: Corporate ESD Programmes

Why They're Valuable:

- **Mandatory spending:** 3% of net profit after tax on ESD^[15]
- **B-BBEE compliance:** Need verifiable supplier development
- **Impact measurement:** Struggling to track programme effectiveness^[16]
- **Less price-sensitive:** Focused on impact, not cost

Top Targets:

Company	ESD Spend	Contact Strategy
Sasol	R12.3B supplier development (2025) ^[17]	Pitch to Head of ESD / Supplier Development
Eskom	R12.3B+ supplier development ^[17]	Pitch to ESD Programme Manager
Sanlam	R143.6M ESD loans ^[7]	Pitch to Head of ESD / CSI
Shoprite Group	Major B-BBEE spend, spaza relationships ^[18]	Pitch to Head of ESD / Supply Chain
Anglo American	Large ESD budget, mining supply chain	Pitch to Head of ESD / Procurement
MTN	Digital inclusion, township focus	Pitch to Head of ESD / Digital Innovation

Pitch to ESD Programmes:

"TradePulse helps you measure the real impact of your R50M+ ESD spend.

For R100–R200/trader/year, you get:

- Real-time monitoring of 500–1,000 supported businesses
- Revenue growth, job creation, sustainability metrics
- Verified data for B-BBEE verification
- Early warning for struggling businesses (proactive support)

Pilot: Track 200 businesses in your current ESD portfolio for 6 months. Show your board: 'X% revenue growth, Y jobs sustained/created, Z% business survival rate.'"

☒ Recommended Client Acquisition Strategy

Phase 1: Months 1–6 (Validate Product)

Target: 1–2 distributors + 100–500 traders

Action Plan:

1. Identify 5–10 distributors in Gauteng/Western Cape
2. Request meetings with Head of General Trade / Distribution
3. Offer free pilot: 50 traders for 3 months
4. Measure: Order volume increase, field rep cost reduction

5. Convert: Paid contract at R80–R120/trader/month

Expected Revenue: R50,000–R100,000/month by Month 6

Phase 2: Months 7–18 (Scale Traction)

Target: 3–5 distributors + 1 bank + 1,000–5,000 traders

Action Plan:

1. Use distributor case studies to pitch more distributors
2. Approach 2–3 banks with verified trading data from 500+ traders
3. Pitch 1–2 ESD programmes with impact measurement angle
4. Hire business development manager with FMCG/banking experience

Expected Revenue: R500,000–R1M/month by Month 18

Phase 3: Months 19–36 (Dominate Market)

Target: 10+ distributors + 3–5 banks + 1–2 government contracts + 25,000–50,000 traders

Action Plan:

1. National distributor contracts (Tiger Brands, Shoprite, Coca-Cola)
2. Bank partnerships for alternative credit scoring (African Bank, Standard Bank)
3. Government tender for TREP/Spaza Fund digital platform
4. Regional expansion (Kenya, Nigeria, Ghana)

Expected Revenue: R5M–R10M/month by Month 36

☒ Your First 10 Outreach Targets

Immediate Priority (Contact in Next 30 Days):

1. Tiger Brands – Head of General Trade / Distribution
2. Shoprite Usave – Head of Informal Trade
3. African Bank – Head of SME Lending (Township Spark)
4. BetaNet W&R Network – CEO / Business Development
5. DSBD (TREP Programme) – Programme Manager
6. Standard Bank – Head of Business Banking / ESD
7. Sasol – Head of ESD / Supplier Development
8. Coca-Cola Beverages SA – Head of Route-to-Market
9. NEF (Spaza Fund) – Investment Manager

10. Capitec – Head of Business Banking

☒ Key Insight: Start with Distributors

Distributors are your best "go-to" client because:

1. ✓ They feel the pain daily (lost orders, field rep costs)
2. ✓ They have budgets (R500–R2,000/trader/month on field reps)
3. ✓ They can onboard traders at scale (50–500 traders per contract)
4. ✓ Quick decision cycle (2–4 weeks vs. 6–12 months for government)
5. ✓ Proven ROI (increase order volume, reduce costs)
6. ✓ Gateway to banks (trading data validates credit risk)
7. ✓ Gateway to government (distributor success = policy win)

Your first win should be a regional distributor with 100–200 spaza relationships. Use that case study to unlock national distributors, then banks, then government.

Bottom Line

Your #1 Go-To Client: FMCG Distributor (e.g., Tiger Brands, Shoprite Usave, regional wholesaler)

Why: Fastest path to revenue, easiest pilot, clearest ROI, scalable model.

Your First Goal: Sign 1 distributor pilot (50–100 traders) within 60 days.

Once you have that, everything else (banks, government, ESD) becomes infinitely easier.

✱✱

1. <https://salesrepsoftware.co.za/resources/blog/whatsapp-orders-costing-distribution-business>
2. <https://betanetportal.co.za/>
3. <https://www.engineeringnews.co.za/article/report-highlights-data-gap-preventing-small-businesses-from-accessing-finance-2025-05-29>
4. https://www.gov.za/sites/default/files/gcis_document/202502/52109gon5869.pdf
5. <https://techcabal.com/2026/08/06/millions-lack-credit-histories-african-banks-are-changing-how-they-lend/>
6. <https://innovationbridge.info/ibportal/article/undp-uncdf-dbsa-and-african-bank-launch-township-spark-ignite-inclusive-growth-south>
7. https://www.standardbank.com/static_file/StandardBankGroup/filedownloads/RTS/2025/SBG_Report_To_Society_2025.pdf
8. <https://www.gov.za/news/speeches/minister-stella-tembisa-ndabeni-small-business-development-dept-budget-vote-202627-19>
9. <https://www.thesouthafrican.com/business/township-and-rural-entrepreneurship-programme/>
10. http://www.dsbd.gov.za/sites/default/files/2025-04/DSBD_2025-26_Annual_Performance_Plan.pdf

11. <https://www.africanleadershipmagazine.co.uk/africas-township-model-south-africas-blueprint-for-local-economic-self-determination/>
12. <https://www.sanews.gov.za/south-africa/digital-platform-support-spaza-shops-goes-live>
13. <https://hotkiosk.com/news/south-africa-smme-budget-r3bn-shops-2026>
14. <https://www.thedtic.gov.za/the-spaza-shop-support-fund-sssf/>
15. <https://topco.co.za/2026/01/30/the-importance-of-ensuring-enterprise-supplier-development/>
16. <https://www.ewn.co.za/2025/10/01/corporates-spend-billions-on-boosting-small-business-so-why-arent-esd-targets-being-met>
17. <https://www.eskom.co.za/wp-content/uploads/2025/10/Eskom-sustainability-report-2025.pdf>
18. <https://www.studocu.com/en-za/document/university-of-south-africa/environmental-management/shoprite-group-sustainability-report-2025/163942503>
19. https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.mss.spazashop&hl=en_ZA
20. <https://www.techinafrica.com/a-new-online-shopping-platform-will-shake-up-the-fmcg-trade/>
21. <https://startupmag.co.za/2025/08/vulekas-breakthrough-how-two-entrepreneurs-built-a-digital-lifeline-for-township-spaza-shops/>
22. <https://expressafrica.co.za/>
23. [https://www.standardbank.co.za/static_file/South Africa/PDF/Township/Standard Bank Township Informal Economy Report October 2025.pdf](https://www.standardbank.co.za/static_file/South%20Africa/PDF/Township/Standard%20Bank%20Township%20Informal%20Economy%20Report%20October%202025.pdf)
24. <https://www.citizen.co.za/sandton-chronicle/news-headlines/2025/10/23/new-ai-tools-target-financially-excluded/>